

TATA BP SOLAR Established 1989

From solar lanterns to solar technology-run ATMs, from traffic and streetlights to railway signals, Tata BP Solar now wants to light up 10 million households across India and generate 20,000 MW of solar power by 2020

SUN SMART

In a country with over 300 sunny days across the country, leveraging solar energy is a relative no-brainer. Even so, entering the market when climate change and global warming were still not considered major worries wasn't easy; it put Tata BP Solar ahead of its time in thinking green. In the late '80s, BP, one of the world's largest integrated energy companies, was looking beyond conventional fossil energy sources for a clean future. On a similar note, Tata Power, one of India's largest private sector power companies, was looking to expand and diversify the sources of power and the technology of production. They joined hands and the joint venture between them started with the 1 MW manufacturing capacity of solar

photo-voltaic cells in Bangalore in 1989.

Initially, Tata BP Solar used solar technology in basic applications like solar lanterns and home lighting systems, but now it has added other applications like streetlights, traffic lights, water pumps and vaccine refrigerators. It has sold more than 50,000 individual solar home lighting systems in the rural areas of Uttar Pradesh during the last two years and has worked in the most remote areas of the country including Jammu and Kashmir, Andaman and Nicobar Islands and the North-east. "Electricity is the key to development and economic growth. In Punjab, solar-powered pumps meant increase in yields, while

solar vaccine refrigerators meant a better health network in India," says K. Subramanya, 56, chief executive officer, Tata BP Solar.

Apart from being responsible for several firsts, Tata BP Solar also has the unique distinction of promoting the individual consumer as a producer of solar power. Their unique concept of the roof-top grid-connect solar power empowers individual consumers to start generating their own power, resulting in multiple benefits like energy security for individuals and, at the same time, generating income by exporting surplus power for the grid. Says Subramanya: "In India, from the solar energy point of view, the per capita consumption is 700 KW per hour. This is just a fraction of the energy demands of the entire nation. Our agenda is to light 10 million households. Government incentives and loans at softer rates will help this mission further." Despite the company's sustained efforts, the de-

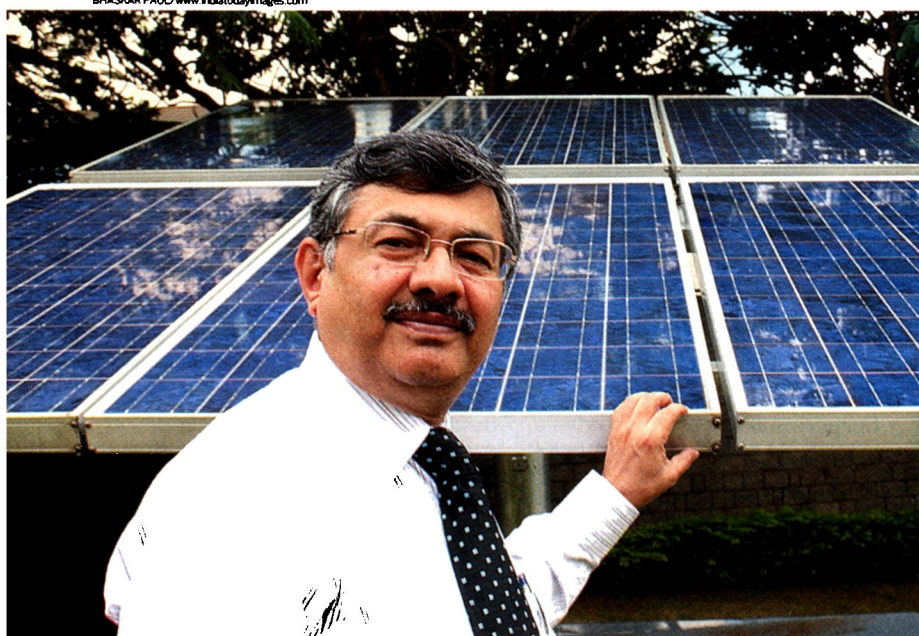
1,500 units
of electricity
can be saved in
a year by using
a 100-litre
domestic solar
water heater
every day.

mand-supply gap in the energy sector continues to be between 12 and 17 per cent. Dismissing the perception that solar power is not so popular in India, he says, "Compared with the cost of delivered electricity, which includes everything from the production

of power to the setting up of grids and distribution network, solar power competes on even terms with alternative forms of energy production."

With the Prime Minister announcing the launch of the Jawaharlal Nehru National Solar Mission, Tata BP Solar's efforts at making solar energy a national concern is on its way to achieving success. From using surplus land to setting up solar plants, to an ambitious target of generating 20,000 MW of solar power by 2020, grid-connected MW-scale solar power plants will be key to achieving this growth aspiration. And as one of the pioneers and market leaders in this field, Tata BP Solar will definitely be an instrument of change.

by Swati Mathur



K. Subramanya 56, CEO

"In Punjab, solar-powered pumps increased yields, while the solar vaccine fridge helped develop a better health network in the country."